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Electronic component and manufacturing method for the same

Abstract

A manufacturing method for an electronic component includes preparing a first composite magnetic section provided with a first composite magnetic layer and at least one marker layer disposed on the first composite magnetic layer; and preparing a second composite magnetic section provided with a second composite magnetic layer and at least one coil formed by winding a conductive wire and buried in the second composite magnetic layer with part of the coil being exposed. The manufacturing method further includes obtaining a multilayer body by disposing the first composite magnetic section so that a surface on the opposite side of the first composite magnetic section to a surface where the marker layer is disposed opposes a surface of the second composite magnetic section; and obtaining a molded body having a marker area formed with non-conductive particles pressed into the first composite magnetic layer.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION (1) This application is a Divisional of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/151,121, filed on Oct. 3, 2018, which claims benefit of priority to Japanese Patent Application No. 2017-198304, filed Oct. 12, 2017, the entire content of which is incorporated herein by reference.

BACKGROUND

Technical Field

(1) The present disclosure relates to an electronic component and a manufacturing method for the same.

Background Art

(2) Of electronic components, there are such electronic components that need to be mounted in a manner in which the front and rear, the direction, and the like thereof must be taken into consideration and adjusted when mounted on a circuit board or the like. As such, electronic components having some markers on their surfaces are well-known as an electronic component whose front and rear, direction, and the like can be identified. However, in a case where a marker is to be attached after the completion of the electronic component, it is necessary to attach the marker after having identified the front and rear, the direction, and the like. This is complicated work. To solve such a problem, methods for attaching a marker during the formation of the electronic component are proposed.

(3) In an electronic component described in Japanese Unexamined Utility Model Registration Application Publication No. 59-65523, since a marker is engraved by punching, a difference in color or a difference in contrast between the marker portion and other portions is small, and therefore it is difficult in some case to recognize the marker with a camera of an automatic appearance inspection machine or the like, for example. In addition, in electronic components described in Japanese Unexamined Patent Application Publication No. 2007-27351 and Japanese Unexamined Patent Application Publication No. 2007-242806, since the marker itself has a thickness, it is necessary to consider the thickness of the marker in designing the outer shape dimension of the electronic component.

SUMMARY

(4) The present disclosure provides an electronic component including a marker that is excellent in identifiability and has substantially no thickness, and a manufacturing method for the stated electronic component.

(5) A first aspect of the present disclosure is a manufacturing method for an electronic component. The method includes preparing a first composite magnetic section provided with a first composite magnetic layer containing magnetic particles and resin, and at least one marker layer disposed on the first composite magnetic layer and containing non-conductive particles; and preparing a second composite magnetic section provided with a second composite magnetic layer containing magnetic

particles and resin, and at least one coil which is formed by winding a conductive wire and is buried in the second composite magnetic layer with part of the coil being exposed. The method further includes obtaining a multilayer body by disposing the first composite magnetic section in such a manner that a surface on the opposite side of the first composite magnetic section to a surface where the above-mentioned marker layer is disposed opposes a surface of the second composite magnetic section where the above-mentioned part of the coil is exposed; and obtaining a molded body having a marker area formed with the non-conductive particles in the marker layer being pressed into the first composite magnetic layer by compression molding of the multilayer body.

(6) A second aspect of the present disclosure is a manufacturing method for an electronic component. The method includes preparing a first composite magnetic section provided with a first composite magnetic layer containing magnetic particles and resin; and preparing a second composite magnetic section provided with a second composite magnetic layer containing magnetic particles and resin, and at least one coil which is formed by winding a conductive wire and is buried in the second composite magnetic layer with part of the coil being exposed. The method further includes disposing at least one marker layer containing non-conductive particles on a surface on the opposite side of the second composite magnetic section to a surface where the above-mentioned part of the coil is exposed; obtaining a multilayer body by disposing the first composite magnetic section on the surface of the second composite magnetic section where the above-mentioned part of the coil is exposed; and obtaining a molded body having a marker area formed with the non-conductive particles in the marker layer being pressed into the second composite magnetic layer by compression molding of the multilayer body.

(7) A third aspect of the present disclosure is an electronic component including an element body containing magnetic particles and resin; a coil incorporated in the element body and formed by winding a conductive wire; a marker area disposed on a surface of the element body and containing non-conductive particles; and a pair of outer electrodes disposed on the surface of the element body and connected to the coil. In the stated electronic component, the non-conductive particles have a smaller volume average particle diameter than the magnetic particles, and the non-conductive particles are disposed between the magnetic particles in the marker area.

(8) According to the present disclosure, it is possible to provide an electronic component including a marker having excellent identifiability and having substantially no thickness, and a manufacturing method for the stated electronic component.

(9) Other features, elements, characteristics and advantages of the present disclosure will become more apparent from the following detailed description of preferred embodiments of the present disclosure with reference to the attached drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1A is a plan view illustrating an external appearance of an electronic component;

(2) FIG. 1B is a transparent plan view of an electronic component;

(3) FIG. 1C is a cross-sectional view of an electronic component taken along a Z-Z plane in FIG. 1B;

(4) FIG. 1D is a partially enlarged cross-sectional view of a marker area of an electronic component;

(5) FIGS. 2A to 2D are cross-sectional views illustrating an outline of a manufacturing process of an electronic component;

(6) FIGS. 3A to 3E are cross-sectional views illustrating another example of a manufacturing process of an electronic component; and

(7) FIGS. 4A to 4C are cross-sectional views illustrating still another example of a manufacturing process of an electronic component.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(8) A manufacturing method for an electronic component of a first aspect of the present disclosure includes first preparation processing configured to prepare a first composite magnetic section provided with a first composite magnetic layer containing magnetic particles and resin, and at least one marker layer disposed on the first composite magnetic layer and containing non-conductive particles; and second preparation processing configured to prepare a second composite magnetic section provided with a second composite magnetic layer containing magnetic particles and resin, and at least one coil which is formed by winding a conductive wire and is buried in the second composite magnetic layer with part of the coil being exposed. The manufacturing method further includes lamination processing configured to obtain a multilayer body by disposing the first composite magnetic section in such a manner that a surface on the opposite side of the first composite magnetic section to a surface where the above-mentioned marker layer is disposed opposes a surface of the second composite magnetic section where the above-mentioned part of the coil is exposed; and molding processing configured to obtain a molded body having a marker area formed with the non-conductive particles in the marker layer being pressed into the first composite magnetic layer by compression molding of the multilayer body.

(9) A manufacturing method for an electronic component of a second aspect of the present disclosure includes first preparation processing configured to prepare a first composite magnetic section provided with a first composite magnetic layer containing magnetic particles and resin; and second preparation processing configured to prepare a second composite magnetic section provided with a second composite magnetic layer containing magnetic particles and resin, and at least one coil which is formed by winding a conductive wire and is buried in the second composite magnetic layer with part of the coil being exposed. The manufacturing method further includes marker disposition processing configured to dispose at least one marker layer containing non-conductive particles on a surface on the opposite side of the second composite magnetic section to a surface where the above-mentioned part of the coil is exposed; lamination processing configured to obtain a multilayer body by disposing the first composite magnetic section on the surface of the second composite magnetic section where the above-mentioned part of the coil is exposed; and molding processing configured to obtain a molded body having a marker area formed with the non-conductive particles in the marker layer being pressed into the second composite magnetic layer by compression molding of the multilayer body.

(10) In the manufacturing methods for the electronic component, after the formation of a multilayer body where a marker layer containing non-conductive particles is disposed on a surface of the electronic component, compression molding is performed on the multilayer body. As a result, the coil is incorporated in an element body formed of the first and second composite magnetic body layers, and the non-conductive particles contained in the marker layer are pressed into a surface of the element body to form a marker area. In the marker area, the non-conductive particles are buried near the surface of the element body, and the marker area has no substantial thickness. In addition, since the non-conductive particles are disposed near the surface of the element body, the marker area can have good identifiability with respect to the areas other than the marker area. Further, by forming the marker area when the coil is incorporated in the element body, it is possible to uniquely determine the positional relationship between a winding axis direction of the coil and the marker area.

(11) In the manufacturing methods, the molded body may incorporate a plurality of coils, and in this case, the manufacturing methods may further include dividing processing configured to divide the molded body incorporating the plurality of coils to obtain divided bodies each including a coil and a marker area.

(12) Since the plurality of coils incorporated in the molded body is disposed having a

predetermined winding axis direction, when the molded body is divided, the positional relationship between the winding axis direction of the coil and the marker area in each individual divided body can be made the same. This makes it possible to efficiently manufacture the electronic components. (13) The manufacturing methods may further include processing of forming an outer electrode to be connected to the coil. By providing the outer electrode, mounting operation on a mounting substrate is facilitated.

(14) An electronic component of a third aspect of the present disclosure includes an element body containing magnetic particles and resin; a coil incorporated in the element body and formed by winding a conductive wire; a marker area disposed on a surface of the element body and containing non-conductive particles; and a pair of outer electrodes disposed on the surface of the element body and connected to the coil. The non-conductive particles have a smaller volume average particle diameter than the magnetic particles, and the non-conductive particles are disposed between the magnetic particles in the marker area.

(15) Because the marker area contains non-conductive particles, the marker area has good identifiability with respect to the areas other than the marker area. In addition, due to the non-conductive particles, it is possible to increase the degrees of freedom in size and arrangement of the outer electrodes and the marker area formed on the surface of the electronic component. Further, since the non-conductive particles have a smaller volume average particle diameter than the magnetic particles, the non-conductive particles enter into gaps formed by the plurality of magnetic particles to be disposed therein, whereby good identifiability is obtained without adding the thickness of the marker area to the element body.

(16) The ratio of the volume average particle diameter of the magnetic particles to the non-conductive particles may be equal to or more than 30. In a case where the volume average particle diameters differ by an amount equal to or more than a predetermined ratio, a larger number of non-conductive particles can be disposed, and an electronic component having more excellent identifiability is constituted.

(17) The magnetic particles used in the electronic component and the manufacturing method therefor may be metal magnetic particles. The metal magnetic material has high saturation magnetic flux density, which makes it easy for the electronic component to reduce the size, reduce the loss, and handle a large current.

(18) Hereinafter, an embodiment of the present disclosure will be described based on the drawings. Note that the following embodiments exemplify an electronic component and a manufacturing method therefor in order to embody the technical idea of the present disclosure, and the present disclosure is not limited to an electronic component and a manufacturing method for the stated electronic component described below. It should be noted that the members described in the appended claims are not limited to the members of the embodiment in any way. In particular, dimensions, materials, shapes, relative arrangement, and the like of the constituent components described in the embodiment are not intended to limit the scope of the present disclosure only to the scope of the embodiment unless otherwise specified, and are merely illustrative.

(19) In the drawings, the same reference numerals denote the same constituent elements. In order to facilitate the explanation or understanding of the essential points, the embodiment is separated and described for the sake of convenience; however, configurations illustrated in different embodiments can be partially replaced or combined with each other. In Working Example 2 and its subsequent Working Examples, the same constituent elements as those in Working Example 1 will not be described, and only different points therefrom will be described. In particular, the same action effects by the same configurations will not be described in each embodiment. In the present specification, the term “process” is intended to encompass not only an independent process but also a process whose purpose is achieved as expected even if it is not clearly distinguishable from other processes. Further, the content of each of components in a composition refers to, in a case where a plurality of materials corresponding to each of the components is present in the composition, a total

amount of the plurality of materials present in the stated composition unless otherwise specified. Moreover, the volume average particle diameter of the magnetic particles and the volume average particle diameter of the non-conductive particles are each determined, by measuring the particle size distribution through the laser diffraction/scattering method, as a particle diameter corresponding to a cumulative volume of 50% from a small diameter side.

Working Example 1

(20) FIG. 1A is a plan view illustrating an example of an external appearance of an electronic component **100** according to Working Example 1. FIG. 1B is a transparent plan view of the electronic component **100**. FIG. 1C is a schematic cross-sectional view taken along a Z-Z plane in FIG. 1B. FIG. 1D is a schematic cross-sectional view in which part of a marker area **14** in FIG. 1C is enlarged and illustrated. The electronic component **100** is, for example, an inductor including a coil and a magnetic body incorporating the coil.

(21) FIG. 1A is a plan view of the electronic component **100** viewed from the side of a surface where the marker area **14** is disposed. The electronic component **100** includes an element body **10**, the marker area **14** disposed on the surface of the element body **10**, and a pair of outer electrodes **16**. The element body **10** of the electronic component **100** is a pressurized compact of a composition containing magnetic particles and resin. The element body **10** is formed containing magnetic particles and a thermosetting resin. As the magnetic particles, metal magnetic particles such as iron-based materials, ferrite, and the like are used, for example. As the thermosetting resin, an epoxy resin or the like is used. The element body **10** incorporates the coil. A pair of lead ends of the coil is exposed to end surfaces in a longitudinal direction of the element body **10** and respectively connected to the outer electrodes **16**. The marker area **14** contains non-conductive particles, and is visually identified as an area different from other areas of the element body **10**. The marker area **14** may be formed in a partial region of one surface of the electronic component **100**, or may be formed on the entirety of one surface thereof. The marker area **14** is formed by non-conductive particles being buried in the element body **10**, and constitutes one surface along with the element body **10**. In FIG. 1A, the marker area **14** is formed in a substantially rectangular shape, but the shape thereof is not particularly limited as long as the shape can be identified as an area different from the area other than the marker area. The shape of the marker area **14** may be a substantially linear shape, a substantially polygonal shape, a substantially circular shape, a substantially elliptical shape, a substantially oval shape or the like, and may be a substantially semicircular shape, a substantial quadrant shape or the like in which part of the above-mentioned shape is removed. In FIG. 1A, each of the outer electrodes **16** is so formed as to extend on the end surface in the longitudinal direction of the element body **10** and also extend across four surfaces orthogonal to the above end surface. The outer electrode **16** may be formed on the end surface in the longitudinal direction of the element body **10** and on at least one surface of the surfaces orthogonal to the end surface. For example, the outer electrode **16** may be provided on the end surface in the longitudinal direction of the element body **10** and on the surface opposing the surface of the element body **10** where the marker area is disposed. In FIG. 1A, although the marker area **14** and the outer electrode **16** are formed being spaced from each other, the outer electrode **16** may be formed while covering part of the marker area **14**.

(22) FIG. 1B is a transparent plan view of the electronic component **100** viewed from the same direction as in FIG. 1A. The element body **10** incorporates a coil **12** formed by winding a conductive wire. A pair of lead ends of the coil **12** is exposed to each of the end surfaces in the longitudinal direction of the element body **10**. For example, the coil **12** is formed by winding a rectangular wire having a substantially rectangular cross section and having an insulating coating thereon. The cross-sectional shape of the conductive wire constituting the coil **12** is not limited to a rectangular shape, and may be a circular shape or a polygonal shape. In addition, a winding method of the coil **12** may be any of an a winding, an edgewise winding, and the like. In FIG. 1B, the pair of lead ends of the coil **12** is connected with the outer electrodes **16** by exposing end surfaces of the

conductive wire to the surface of the element body **10**, but may be connected with the outer electrodes **16** by exposing side surfaces of the conductive wire to the surface of the element body **10**. In the electronic component **100**, the marker area **14** is disposed on a surface orthogonal to the winding axis direction of the coil **12**.

(23) FIG. 1C is a schematic cross-sectional view obtained by cutting the electronic component **100** along the Z-Z plane in FIG. 1B, in a direction parallel to the winding axis direction of the coil **12**. In FIG. 1C, the coil **12** formed by winding a conductive wire in two tiers is incorporated in the element body **10**. The marker area **14** is formed by non-conductive particles being buried in a surface region of the element body **10**. The surface of the marker area **14** forms one surface along with the surface of the element body **10**. In another mode, the surface of the marker area may be disposed closer to the element body side relative to the surface of the element body. In other words, the marker area may be formed as a recessed section on the surface of the element body.

(24) FIG. 1D is a schematic cross-sectional view in which a portion near the surface of the marker area **14** is enlarged and illustrated. The marker area **14** is configured to contain a magnetic particle **10a**, resin **10b**, and a non-conductive particle **14a**. In the marker area **14**, the non-conductive particles **14a** having a smaller volume average particle diameter are buried in gaps formed between the magnetic particles **10a** having a larger volume average particle diameter. Since the volume average particle diameter of the non-conductive particles is small, a sufficient amount of the non-conductive particles **14a** for the identification can be disposed without reducing the content of the magnetic particles **10a**. The ratio of the volume average particle diameter of the magnetic particles **10a** to the non-conductive particles **14a** is, for example, equal to or more than 10, and preferably equal to or more than 30. The magnetic particles **10a** may be metal magnetic particles such as iron-based materials, ferrite, or the like. The volume average particle diameter of the magnetic particles **10a** is, for example, equal to or larger than 1 μm and equal to or smaller than 100 μm (i.e., from 1 μm to 100 μm). The non-conductive particles **14a** are, for example, metallic oxide particles such as alumina or zinc oxide materials, and the volume average particle diameter thereof is, for example, less than 1 μm . Further, the non-conductive particles **14a** may have a color tone different from that of the magnetic particles **10a**, or may be arbitrarily colored particles.

Working Example 2

(25) FIGS. 2A to 2D are schematic process diagrams explaining a manufacturing method for an electronic component **200** of the present embodiment, and cross-sectional views for each processing of the manufacturing method are illustrated in FIGS. 2A to 2D. In FIG. 2A, prepared is a first composite magnetic section **210** including a first composite magnetic layer **20** containing magnetic particles and resin, and a marker layer **24** disposed on the first composite magnetic layer **20** and containing non-conductive particles. It is sufficient for the marker layer **24** to contain non-conductive particles, and the marker layer **24** may contain resin in addition to the non-conductive particles. In the case where the marker layer **24** contains resin, the resin may be the same kind of resin as the resin constituting the first composite magnetic layer, or may be a different kind of resin therefrom. The marker layer **24** is formed, for example, by applying a paste containing non-conductive particles and resin onto a surface of the first composite magnetic layer **20** by printing or the like. In addition, in FIG. 2A, prepared is a second composite magnetic section **220** including a second composite magnetic layer **21** containing magnetic particles and resin, and a coil **22** formed by winding a conductive wire. In the second composite magnetic section **220**, the coil **22** is partially buried in the second composite magnetic layer **21**, and an upper surface portion of the coil **22** is exposed on the second composite magnetic layer **21**. Although only the upper surface of the coil **22** is exposed from the second composite magnetic layer **21** in FIG. 2A, the upper surface and part of the side surface of the coil **22** may be exposed. The second composite magnetic section **220** can be prepared by inserting the coil **22** into the second composite magnetic layer **21** along the winding axis direction of the coil.

(26) In FIG. 2B, a multilayer body in which the first composite magnetic section and the second

composite magnetic portion are laminated is obtained. In the multilayer body, the second composite magnetic section in which the coil **22** is buried, the first composite magnetic layer **20**, and the marker layer **24** are laminated in this order. The multilayer body is formed by laminating the first composite magnetic section and the second composite magnetic section in a manner in which the surface on the opposite side of the first composite magnetic section to the surface where the marker layer is disposed opposes the surface of the second composite magnetic section where the coil **22** is exposed.

(27) In FIG. **2C**, the multilayer body obtained in FIG. **2B** is compression-molded along the winding axis direction of the coil **22** to obtain a compact. The compact includes an element body **28** incorporating the coil **22** and a marker area **25** integrally formed with the element body **28** on the surface of the element body **28**. The element body **28** is formed by the first composite magnetic layer and the second composite magnetic layer being integrated, and contains magnetic particles and resin. By performing compression molding on the multilayer body of FIG. **2B**, the non-conductive particles contained in the marker layer **24** are pressed into the first composite magnetic layer to form the marker area **25**. At the same time, the first composite magnetic layer is integrated with the second composite magnetic body layer to form the element body **28**. Compression molding of the multilayer body may be performed in a manner in which the multilayer body is set in a mold and pressurized in the winding axis direction of the coil **22**. In addition, during the compression molding of the multilayer body, heat may be applied along with the pressure. In the case of heating, for example, it is sufficient for the heating temperature to be a temperature at which the resin cures; that is, the temperature may be equal to or lower than 200° C., and preferably equal to or lower than 150° C., for example. Since the marker layer **24** is disposed on a predetermined surface, and then the non-conductive particles contained in the marker layer **24** are pressed into the element body to form the marker area **25**, it is possible to efficiently manufacture an electronic component in which the winding axis direction of the incorporated coil can be easily identified. In addition, in a case where the marker area **25** is formed as a recessed section on the surface of the element body, the manufacturing method may further include processing of removing part of the surface of the marker area **25**.

(28) In FIG. **2D**, a pair of outer electrodes **26** respectively connected to a pair of lead ends (not illustrated) of the coil **22** is formed on the surface of the element body **28** incorporating the coil **22**. Each of the outer electrodes **26** is formed with a conductive paste containing a metal such as silver, copper, or the like. The pair of lead ends of the coil **22** may be exposed from the second composite magnetic layer **21** when forming the second composite magnetic section, or may be exposed from the element body **28** by cutting part of the element body **28** after the compression molding of the multilayer body.

Working Example 3

(29) FIGS. **3A** to **3E** are schematic process diagrams explaining another example of a manufacturing method for an electronic component **300** of the present embodiment, and cross-sectional views for each processing of the manufacturing method are illustrated in FIGS. **3A** to **3E**. The manufacturing method of Working Example 3 is different from the manufacturing method of Working Example 2 in that a marker layer **34** is disposed on a second composite magnetic section. In FIG. **3A**, prepared is a first composite magnetic section **310** including a first composite magnetic layer **30** containing magnetic particles and resin. In addition, in FIG. **3A**, prepared is a second composite magnetic section **320** including a second composite magnetic layer **31** containing magnetic particles and resin, and a coil **32** formed by winding a conductive wire. In the second composite magnetic section **320**, the coil **32** is buried in the second composite magnetic layer **31** while exposing the upper surface thereof from the second composite magnetic layer **31**.

(30) In FIG. **3B**, the marker layer **34** containing non-conductive particles is disposed on a surface on the opposite side of the second composite magnetic layer **31** to the surface where the coil **32** is exposed. For example, the marker layer **34** is formed by applying a paste containing non-

conductive particles and resin to the second composite magnetic layer **31** by printing or the like. (31) In FIG. **3C**, a multilayer body in which the first composite magnetic section and the second composite magnetic section are laminated is obtained. In the multilayer body, the first composite magnetic section is laminated on the second composite magnetic section in which the coil **32** is buried, and the marker layer **34** is laminated on the second composite magnetic layer **31**. The multilayer body is formed by laminating the first composite magnetic section and the second composite magnetic section in a manner in which the first composite magnetic section opposes the surface of the second composite magnetic section where the coil **32** is exposed.

(32) In FIG. **3D**, the multilayer body obtained in FIG. **3C** is compression-molded along the winding axis direction of the coil **32** to obtain a molded body. The molded body includes an element body **38** incorporating the coil **32** and a marker area **35** integrally formed with the element body **38** on the surface of the element body **38**. The element body **38** is formed by the first composite magnetic layer and the second composite magnetic layer being integrated, and contains magnetic particles and resin. By performing compression molding on the multilayer of FIG. **3C**, the non-conductive particles contained in the marker layer **34** are pressed into the second composite magnetic layer to form the marker area **35**. At the same time, the second composite magnetic layer is integrated with the first composite magnetic layer to form the element body **38**.

(33) In FIG. **3E**, a pair of outer electrodes **36** respectively connected to a pair of lead ends of the coil **32** is formed on the surface of the element body **38** incorporating the coil **32**. Each of the outer electrodes **36** is formed with a conductive paste containing a metal such as silver or copper. The pair of lead ends of the coil **32** may be exposed from the second composite magnetic layer **31** when forming the second composite magnetic section, or may be exposed from the element body **38** by cutting part of the element body **38** after the compression molding of the multilayer body.

Working Example 4

(34) FIGS. **4A** to **4C** are schematic process diagrams explaining still another example of a manufacturing method for an electronic component of the present embodiment, and plan views or transparent plan views for each processing of the manufacturing method are illustrated in FIGS. **4A** to **4C**. The manufacturing method of Working Example 4 is different from the manufacturing method of Working Example 2 in that a second composite magnetic section includes a plurality of coils. FIG. **4A** illustrates plan views of a first composite magnetic section **410** and a second composite magnetic section **420**. The first composite magnetic section **410** includes a first composite magnetic layer **40** containing magnetic particles and resin, and at least one marker layer **44** disposed on the first composite magnetic layer **40** and containing non-conductive particles. For example, the marker layer **44** is formed by applying a paste containing non-conductive particles and resin onto one surface of the first composite magnetic layer **40** by printing or the like. In FIG. **4A**, a plurality of marker layers **44** is provided, and each marker layer is so disposed as to correspond to a coil **42** in the second composite magnetic section **420**. Further, the marker layer **44** may be so disposed as to cover the entirety of one surface of the first composite magnetic layer **40**. The second composite magnetic section **420** includes a second composite magnetic layer **41** containing magnetic particles and resin, and the coil **42** formed by winding a conductive wire. In the second composite magnetic section **420**, the coil **42** is partially buried in the second composite magnetic layer **41**, and an upper surface of the coil **42** is exposed on the second composite magnetic layer **41**. The second composite magnetic section **420** is prepared in the following manner: a plurality of coils **42** is disposed on one surface of the second composite magnetic layer **41** while adjusting winding axis directions of the coils and further adjusting lead portions from the coils, and then the coils **42** are inserted into the second composite magnetic layer **41** along the winding axis directions of the coils **42**.

(35) FIG. **4B** is a transparent plan view of a compact **430** obtained by performing compression molding on a multilayer body of the first composite magnetic section and the second composite magnetic section. The first composite magnetic section and the second composite magnetic section

are laminated in the same manner as in Working Example 2, thereby forming the multilayer body. The molded body is obtained by performing compression molding on the multilayer body along the winding axis direction of the coil **42**. The molded body includes an element body **48** incorporating the plurality of coils **42**, and a plurality of marker areas **45** integrally formed with the element body **48** on the surface of the element body **48**. The plurality of marker areas **45** is respectively arranged corresponding to the coils **42**.

(36) FIG. **4C** illustrates transparent plan views of a plurality of divided bodies **49** obtained by dividing a molded body incorporating the plurality of coils **42**. The divided body **49** includes an element body containing magnetic particles and resin, the coil **42** incorporated in the element body, and the marker area **45** disposed on the element body. The divided body **49** is formed by cutting the compact in arrow directions in FIG. **4B**, for example. In the divided body **49**, a pair of lead ends of the coil **42** is exposed on a surface of the element body. An electronic component is manufactured by forming outer electrodes to be respectively connected to the pair of lead ends of the coil **42** on the surface of the divided body **49**. By disposing the marker layer **44** on a predetermined surface in advance and forming the marker area **45** based on the marker layer **44**, it is possible to efficiently manufacture an electronic component in which the winding axis direction of the incorporated coil can be identified.

(37) While preferred embodiments of the disclosure have been described above, it is to be understood that variations and modifications will be apparent to those skilled in the art without departing from the scope and spirit of the disclosure. The scope of the disclosure, therefore, is to be determined solely by the following claims.

Claims

1. An electronic component comprising: an element body containing magnetic particles and resin; a coil incorporated in the element body and formed by winding a conductive wire; a marker area disposed on a surface of the element body and containing non-conductive particles; and a pair of outer electrodes disposed on the surface of the element body and connected to the coil, wherein the non-conductive particles have a smaller volume average particle diameter than that of the magnetic particles, and the non-conductive particles are disposed between the magnetic particles in the marker area.
 2. The electronic component according to claim 1, wherein a ratio of the volume average particle diameter of the magnetic particles to the volume average particle diameter of the non-conductive particles is equal to or greater than 30.
 3. The electronic component according to claim 1, wherein the magnetic particles are metal magnetic particles.
 4. The electronic component according to claim 1, wherein at least one of the outer electrodes is spaced from the marker area.
 5. The electronic component according to claim 1, wherein at least one of the outer electrodes covers a portion of a surface of the molded body including the marker area.
 6. The electronic component according to claim 1, wherein the non-conductive particles are metallic oxide particles.
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